# Stuart's Stepmother Could be the Devil

## By Jay M. Dean

**STUART:** **(Pg 15-20)** Allo. My name is Stuart . . . and I have LOTS of cool stuff. For example, this is my cat Tobias.

**CAT:** Hissss . . .

**STUART:** He pretty much hates me.

**CAT:** Rawr . . .

**STUART:** And he's hideous. He used to be ok until I burned all his fur off. I probably shouldn't have done that. I am what they call a pyromaniac. It's a disease. But I have a much bigger problem. I have what they like to call "an over-active imagination." *(looks off, poof poof) (Imagination scene to be created by the actor)*

**STUART:** Apparently an overactive imagination is only good in Disneyland. But I digress . . . I like my hideous cat cuz he talks when you squeeze him.

**CAT:** Rawr . . .

**STUART:** Sort of . . .

**STEPMOTHER:** Stuart! Your cat puked on the rug . . . again . . . Get down here and clean it up . . . now!

**STUART:** That's my stepmother. She's evil . . . like in the fairytales.

**CAT:** Hiss . . .

**STUART:** My thoughts exactly Tobias . . .You know . . . *(petting cat)* it's ok that my cat's super ugly and sounds like Janet Reno cuz . . . wanna know a secret? He's magic. *(holds out cat)*

## INTRODUCTION

*My Stepmother Could be the Devil by Jay M. Dean*

**CAT:** Rawr . . .

**STUART:** *looking at cat)* Yah magical. He grants wishes! He can grant whatever wish that I wish when I squeeze him and wish something. It's pretty sweet . . . Oh . . . except it's only in my brain. Apparently, Tobias is just the primary extension of my over-active imagination manifesting itself physically in my pet cat. *(Smiles)* Yah. At least that's what the therapist told my stepmother.

**STEPMOTHER:** Stuart! Get your grounded little tookis down to breakfast . . . now!

**STUART:** Coming!

**STEPMOTHER:** Stop talking like that! You're not Winston Churchill!

**STUART:** But . . . **STEPMOTHER:** No!

**STUART:** But . . . **STEPMOTHER:** No!

**STUART:** Really? **STEPMOTHER:** Yes.

**STUART:** NO! She's the destroyer of all that is good in the world. . . Hey! So, remember when I said I had lots of cool stuff? Yah, that was a lie. All I have in the world is my magic cat, Tobias.

**CAT:** Hiss . . .

**STUART:** What did I ever do to you? I have lost all my worldly possessions because that tyrannical overlord . . . you know . . .

**STEPMOTHER:** Stuart!

**STUART:** Her . . . the bringer of unmitigated evil . . . has taken it all for no reason. Or it could be because I'm grounded. Whatever. It all started last week with my teacher, Ms. Fairywinkle . . .

**MS FAIRWINKLE:** Stuart! What is the matter with you?

**STUART:** I'm a pyromanic . . . **MS FAIRWINKLE:** No . . .

**STUART:** It's a disease.

**MS FAIRWINKLE:** No! I mean this. Do you know what card I have in my hand?

**STUART:** The queen of spades? **MS FAIRWINKLE:** No . . .

**STUART:** The four of clubs? **MS FAIRWINKLE:** No!

**STUART:** Really?

**MS FAIRWINKLE:** Yes! I mean . . . No! I mean . . . Yes! Never mind. This is your report card. Just look at your grades. Science D, Reading D, Writing F, Math F!

**STUART:** Well, Ms. Fairywonkle, I guess I need to be spending less time on Science and Reading.

**MS FAIRWINKLE:** I am going to have the principal sign this and then I'm sending it home to your stepmother.

**STUART:** That was bad news. When I got home, I had a serious conversation with Tobias: What are we gonna do? I've got to get that report card before anyone else sees it.

**CAT:** Rawr . . .

**STUART:** What's that? Sneak into the principal's office and get it? No way! The principal's office is heavily guarded. We'll never get inside. It's an impossible mission . . . Wait a tick . . . *(picks up cat)* Tobias, I have a wish. I need you to turn me into Tom Cruise . . . minus all the creepy stuff. *(Holds out cat, squeezes him)*

**CAT:** Rawr . . . *(Magic transition sound, 270 spin to the right)*

*(Mission Impossible Theme, putting on stealth vest and sneaking into the principal's office, opening a file cabinet and pulling out a report card – As he does so, he verbalizes the following objects as if reading signs that appear on each object: Principal's Office, Tom Cruise, File Cabinet and Report Card.)*

**STUART:** Everything is labeled in this place! (Finished Mission Impossible Theme) And then I stopped. *(Removing vest)* Stealing is wrong. Plus, couldn't all this just be a figment of my over-active imagination. *(Report card disappears)* And I realized – Yes . . . yes it could.

**MS FAIRWINKLE:** Stuart! Get down off your desk! You are not a monkey and this is not a zoo. . . what the *heck*!

**STUART:** Sorry Ms. Farfigwinkle.

**MS FAIRWINKLE:** I don't know what is causing this wild behavior, but since you can't seem to get your head out of the clouds, I'm going to have to put in a call to . . . *(devil's voice)* Your Stepmother! *(evil laugh)*

**STUART:** Noooo! *(beat)* So, I'm pretty *doomed*, then. I don't know what to do, so I decide to sleep on it. *(falls asleep, alarm sounds immediately, wakes up)* I wake up refreshed and . . . still don't have a plan. As I eat my breakfast, Tobias comes up with a brilliant plan.

**CAT:** Rawr . . .

**STUART:** What's that? Why yes, I suppose we could . . . create a potion to erase the dark one's memory . . . if my stepmother can't remember my grades, then I can't get in trouble for them! Tobias, I have a wish. I need you to turn me into a really amazing scientist . . . like the guy who invented Poptarts. *(to the audience)* I love Poptarts. *(Holds out cat, squeezes him)*

**CAT:** Rawr . . . *(Magic transition sound, 360 degree turn with hands in the air like a mad scientist)*

**STUART:** Good. *(clears throat)* You put two drops in *(sounds: drop, drop, poof!)* You take two drops out *(sounds: slurp, slurp, pop!)* You put three cups in *(sounds: swoop, plop, swoop, plop, swoop, plop, poof!)* and you shake it all about *(sounds: squeeze, drop, drop, slurp, plop, poof!)* You make yourself a potion just to knock your stepmom out. That's what it's all about! *(plop, poof!)* There, all finished.

**STEPMOTHER:** Stuart?!? Oh, there you are . . . let's go. You're going to be late for school!

**STUART:** Oh, but you look so parched stepmother. Perhaps you would like a drink? *(offers cup)*

**STEPMOTHER:** Why Stuart? Did you make Tang? Why, thank you. I love Tang. *(She drinks, gulp gulp)* Mmmm. Delicious.

**STUART:** And then I stopped. Using a potion to erase someone's memory is wrong. And couldn't this just be my over-active imagination, and couldn't that just be regular, potion free Tang? And I realized, yes, yes it could.

**STEPMOTHER:** Ok, Stuart. School is starting in 15 minutes! You don't want to be late for school! Let's go.

**STUART:** Wait a tick! That's it!

**STEPMOTHER:** What's it?

**STUART:** Nothing.

**STEPMOTHER:** Really?

**STUART:** Yep.

**STEPMOTHER:** OK! . . . I'll be waiting in the car . . .

**STUART:** Tobias, I've got one more wish. If I can't get rid of my report card, I'll have to think a little bigger . . . Tobias, I wish there was no such thing as school! (Hold out cat, squeezes him)

**CAT:** Rawr . . . *(Magic transition sound, 180-degree spin)*

**MS FAIRWINKLE:** *(Facing back)* Stuart! Stuart! Come to class!

**STUART:** *(slowly turning, a little crazy)* But I can't Ms. Fairyfarkle! There is no class! School doesn't exist! The only thing on the lesson plan today is chaos! And everyone is getting an "A"! Ha! Ha!

**MS FAIRWINKLE:** Stuart! If school doesn't exist, then where are you right now?

**STUART:** *(Looks around)* That is an excellent point, Ms. Fairyfignuten.

**MS FAIRWINKLE:** *(cold, but concerned)* Stuart . . . I think you had better go home.

**STUART:** Okay, Ms. Fairyfart *(to the audience)* I am in a terrible amount of trouble! *(Starts turning, stops)* I wonder if my death will be very painful . . . *(finishes 360-degree turn)*

**STEPMOTHER:** Stuart . . . what is wrong with you?

**STUART:** I'm a pyromaniac.

**STEPMOTHER:** No . . .

**STUART:** It's a disease.

**STEPMOTHER:** No . . . look, I know things have been hard since your father passed away. But you can't keep disappearing into that imaginary world of yours when we need you here. I want you to know that if I'm strict, it's just because I want what's best for you.

**STUART:** Oh. I have misjudged this situation terribly. Well, I have something to tell you, but you're not going to like it.

**STEPMOTHER:** That's ok; I don't like most things.

**STUART:** There is a very bad report card on its way to this house. And . . . it's mine.

**STEPMOTHER:** I know.

**STUART:** What?

**STEPMOTHER:** Yep.

**STUART:** How?

**STEPMOTHER:** Ms. Fairywinkle told me about your poopy grades last week. I was wondering when you would work up the courage to tell me.

**STUART:** Oh . . . well, since I was so terribly honest . . . is there any way . . .

**STEPMOTHER:** *(laughs)* Oh . . . yeah. No. You're grounded.

**STUART:** I see *(360-degree turn)* So that's how I ended up here, with nothing to do. My over-active imagination got the best of me . . . But I did learn a lesson. . . and when I figure out what it is I'll let you know. Meanwhile, I'm sure I can find something to pass the time. *(Strikes match)*

**CAT:** *(terrified)* Rawr . . .

## SOURCE INFORMATION

*Author: Jay M. Dean*
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## AWARD HISTORY

*2016 National Qualifier*
*2020 National Qualifier – MS*
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*2024 National Qualifier*
*CA State Qualifier*
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